INCH-POUND

A-A-54707
24 July 1992

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

INDICATOR, STERILIZATION

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Federal Specification GG-I-00521b which is cancelled.

This Commercial Item Description covers two types of sterilization indicators, suitable for use in determining whether or not sterilizing temperature has been reached in the sterilizing chamber of autoclaves and sterilizers.

Salient characteristics:

The sterilization indicator shall consist of a straight, heat sealed, glass tube approximately 1-3/4 inches long and approximately 1/4 inch in diameter containing a small tablet of solid material.

The indicators covered by this specification shall be of the following types:

TYPE	Fusible Temperature, °F
I	252°, +4°, -2°
II	272°, +4°, -2°

The small chemical tablet shall melt and fuse as an indication that sterilization temperature, within the range specified above for type I or II respectively, has been attained.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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There shall be a constriction near one end of the tube to which a length of not less than 12 inches of nylon thread is secured for withdrawing the indicator from the sterilizer load in which it was packed. The thread shall have a breaking strength of not less than 4 pounds.

Manufacturer's instructions shall be furnished with each unit of sterilization indicator.

Workmanship. The sterilization indicator shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Package (PG). One package containing one hundred sterilization indicators, of the type specified, constitutes one unit.

QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.5 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-II. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one package of 100 sterilization indicators.

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Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1 (percent defective) and an inspection level of S-2. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one package of 100 sterilization indicators.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. Tests shall include, but shall not be limited to the following:

Determination of melting point. Melting point of the indicator shall be determined by attaching the indicator tube to a thermometer calibrated to 250°F ± 1°F for Type I indicators, and 270°F ± 1°F for Type II indicators. The indicator tube shall be adjacent to the thermometer bulb. The thermometer, with indicator tube attached, shall be placed in an oil bath (preheated to 212°F) so that the indicator tube is completely immersed in the oil. The temperature of the oil shall be raised slowly until 218°F is reached for Type I indicators, and 240°F for Type II indicators. Heating shall continue, with constant stirring, so that the temperature rises at a rate of 3°F per minute. When the temperature reaches 243°F for Type I indicators and 267°F for Type II indicators, heating shall be reduced so that the temperature rises at a rate of 1°F to 2°F per minute. Heating shall continue until melting is complete. The temperature at which the tablet is observed to collapse definitely against the side of the tube shall be recorded as the beginning of melting, and the temperature at which the tablet becomes liquid throughout shall be recorded as the end of melting or the melting point. The sample shall be removed from the bath, allowed to cool and re-solidify. Sample shall then be examined for fused conditions.

Breaking strength. Breaking strength shall be determined in accordance with ASTM Method No. D3759.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction , the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered material. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

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Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

NSN	Item Identification	TYPE
6530-00-708-5326	INDICATOR, STERILIZATION	I
6530-00-935-1124	INDICATOR, STERILIZATION	II

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army-MD
Navy-MS
Air Force-03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
USPHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-2353

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS

1 The preparing activity must complete blocks 1, 2, 3, and 8 In block 1, both the document number and revision letter should be given.

2 The submitter of this form must complete blocks 4, 5, 6, and 7.

3 The preparing activity must provide a reply within 30 days from receipt of the form

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, or clarification of requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constutute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements

I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1 DOCUMENT NUMBER A-A-5470	2 DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD) 24 July 1992

3 DOCUMENT TITLE
INDICATOR, STERILIZATION

4 NATURE OF CHANGE *(Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible Attach extra sheets as needed)*

5 REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8 PREPARING ACTIVITY

a NAME	b TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial	(2) AUTOVON
Defense Personnel Support Center	(215) 737-2870	444-2870
c ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) ATTN: MSE 2800 S. 20th Street Philadelphia, PA 19145	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

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